

LEDGER · 2026-08-29 · AQUACULTURE BIOTECHNOLOGY

AHPND-Targeting Bacteriophage Suspensions via Rapid Broth Fermentation

REJECTED

This concept did **not** clear the framework.
The reasoning is published in full below.
What the assessment found

Incumbent benchmark	Florfenicol 20% premix
Entry application	Shrimp Nursery Phase (post-larvae stages PL15 to PL30)
Measured advantage	~0.95x survival rate (78.5% phage vs 80-83% Florfenicol) in AHPND challenge models
Time to first revenue	18 months
Gross margin at parity	44.3%
Startup CapEx	\$210,995
Payback from first sale	11.2 months
Capital productivity	4.14x

Regulatory risk

Moderate — qualification costs reported (\$150,000 estimated)

Why it failed

- Voided by: Economics undisclosed, Negative control / sub-2x, Form-factor / handling regression
- Margin fails the operating-cost check

Assessment

The proposed phage therapy explicitly concedes failure against the 2.0x performance threshold, showing a survival regression (~0.95x) against market leader Florfenicol. Gross margins at the incumbent price reach only 42.3% (below the required 70%), and the liquid formulation introduces severe form-factor regressions compared to stable dry premixes.

Also flagged

- Evidence rests on non-peer-reviewed sources
- Duplicate references inflating the evidence base
- Price parity asserted, not sourced

A rejection is not a claim that the science is wrong. It means the venture case did not survive: the comparator was not what the buyer actually buys, the comparison was not like-for-like, the advantage fell short of a step change, or the capital and time to first revenue were prohibitive.

Assessed 2026-08-29 against seven gates plus the voiding sub-tests. [How the method works](#) · [Browse all concepts](#)

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